

THERE'S LEVELS *To This*

**HOW TO GO
FROM
ANOINTED
TO APPOINTED**



Lee Martinez

There's Levels to This

How to go from Anointed to Activated

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Unless otherwise indicated, scripture quotations are from the English standard version Bible. Scriptures marked KJV are taken from the King James version (KJV): King James version, public domain

Introduction

World-renowned author Mark Twain once said, **“The two most important days of your life are the day you were born and the day you find out why.”** One of the most important days for a believer is when God’s purpose for our lives is revealed to us. After we repent, decide to be born again, go through discipleship, build an intimate relationship with the Holy Spirit, and give ourselves to servanthood in the Kingdom, our calling is identified in our lives.

This moment in our lives is usually marked by either a physical or spiritual (or both) pouring of oil. This is what we call **“ANOINTMENT.”** When this occurs, we begin to flow, covered with God’s grace in our homes, work, schools, and kingdom life that are connected to what we have been anointed to do. What seems difficult for others to figure out will come to you naturally. New, creative ideas will flow out of you like honey in the areas you have been anointed to function in.

It is imperative to understand that anointing goes beyond the four walls of the church. Anointing is not confined to a microphone, to an instrument, or even a pulpit. In the Kingdom, God has anointed many to function beyond the church structure. Some are anointed to function in the marketplace, the music industry, the political arena, the judicial system, media, and in every other arena in which the Kingdom of God is established.

There is no arena on the planet where God can't save souls, and the name of Jesus be glorified!

But we must also not confuse ANOINTED with ACTIVATED.

Webster's dictionary defines anointed as: applying oil to as part of a religious ceremony. **To designate as if by a ritual anointment.**

Designate means to **indicate and set apart for a specific purpose, office. or duty.**

In the Cambridge English Dictionary activated is defined as **to cause something to start.**

When you have been anointed, you have been designated or indicated and set apart for a specific purpose, office, or duty. However, there are levels to this. Although you have been anointed to do something, it doesn't mean that you are ready to make it active or cause it to start. Being anointed to do it does not mean that you have been activated to do it.

In the Kingdom of God, activation can be defined as “the action or process of making active and operative in such person's gifts, calling, and/or Ministry office (according to God's will, authority, and sovereignty).

The anointing qualifies you; not for the activation, but for the preparation. It is the anointing, combined with the preparation, that will bring you to activation.

Wherefore I put thee in remembrance that thou stir up the gift of God, which is in thee by the putting on of my hands.
2 Timothy 1:6

“Gift of God”, in the Greek, is *charisma*. The word charisma means **endowment, religious qualification.**

What the Apostle Paul is saying in this verse is to “rekindle the religious qualification of God, which is in you, by the putting, or laying on, of my hands.” There is biblical foundation, and biblical mandate, when it comes to the activation of one’s gift, calling, and/or office. Many people don’t like this concept because, although you might have a calling or a word that you have a gift, calling, and/or office, you must first be approved. There are levels to getting to the place of being approved and activated.

As I began to pray and search the scriptures for direction and confirmation when it comes to how to properly walk the journey of reaching the level of activation, I was able to find all I needed in the story of one man’s life, who the scripture declares in 1 Samuel 13:14 to be ‘a man after God's heart.’

Let’s take a deep look into the journey king David went on, from the moment he was anointed by the prophet Samuel, to the moment in which the crown was placed on his head and was declared the king of Israel. My goal is to help you gain a deeper

understanding and guidance to the levels of going from anointed to activated.

Revelation: Revealed by God to you & Them

In the book of 1 Samuel chapter 13, we read that after King Saul had not kept the commandments of the Lord, which he had commanded of King Saul, and had taken it upon himself to offer burnt offering (which he had no authority to do), the prophet Samuel speaks to him in verse 14, “but now your Kingdom shall not continue. The Lord has sought out a man after his own heart, and the Lord has commanded him to be Prince over his people, because you have not kept what the Lord commanded you.”

In this text, we read that the prophet Samuel is alerting King Saul to the fact that, because of his disobedience and dishonor, his reign will come to an end, and that the Lord has already chosen someone to take his place. Later in the text, we realize that this man that has been chosen is David, son of Jesse. He later becomes none other than the great King David, king of Israel. This is also the lineage through which our Lord and savior Jesus Christ is born from. But notice how David is not present in this scene. As a matter of fact, David’s identity has not even been revealed to the prophet Samuel. God begins to reveal David’s calling to Samuel, even before dealing with David about it.

There comes a moment in our walk with God when the Lord begins to tug at our spirit regarding our calling and purpose. He

begins to reveal himself to us through dreams, visions, sermons preached, and other gifts of the Kingdom. We begin to experience an empowerment and grace in certain skills, and an innate ability to solve problems when others cannot figure it out.

As we are receiving the revelation of what we have been anointed to do, God is also revealing this to someone else or to others that will be assigned to you. The assignment might be for a short period of time. Others will be assigned to you for the long term. They are found in the position of activated. They are active in their calling and purpose. They are actively operating in their office. God will begin to reveal what he has anointed you to do and be to those who are already operating and being successful in their calling.

What this does is confirm, affirm, and validate what you believe the Lord has revealed to you. They might not be famous, have a full preaching agenda, lead a 10,000-member ministry, or run a Fortune 500 company, but not only will they have proven success to show, they will also show sustainability, which is just as important. There is no true success without sustainability.

They Didn't Expect It Would Be You

The Lord spoke to Samuel and said, “how long will you grieve over Saul, since I have rejected him from being King over Israel? Fill your horn with oil, and go, I will send you to Jesse the Bethlehemite, for I have provided for myself a king among his sons” (1 Samuel 16:1 KJV).

God had made a judgment over King Saul, and declared that his reign will be over. The prophet Samuel is mourning for King Saul. Although Samuel understands, and agrees with God's decision, we still see the prophet Samuel grieving by what has happened with Saul. You need to understand that they had a history together and made history together. It was the prophet Samuel that God sent to Saul to anoint as Israel's first King. The prophet saw greatness in Saul, but was now lamenting that Saul would never walk into the fullness of who he could have been. In the middle of Samuel coming to terms with this, God shows up and basically lets him know that it's time to get over it because He'd chosen another.

God sends the prophet to the house of Jesse. When the prophet Samuel arrives at the house, we see that Jesse has eight sons and brings each of them into the presence of the prophet, one by one.

Something very interesting happen in verse 6. The Bible says that when Jesse brings him his son Eliab he takes a look at him and says “surely the Lord's anointed is before me.” It seemed like Samuel had a type, an image, a likeness, a model of what

the king should look like. On top of that he was also mourning and grieving over the fact that he was about to lose Saul as the king. Although the bible doesn't specifically say it, I get the impression that when Samuel looked at Eliab, he saw a young Saul. The Lord then answers Samuel in verse 7 and says, "look not on his countenance, or on the height of his stature, because I have refused him: for the Lord sees not as man sees; for men look at on the outward appearance, but the Lord looketh on the heart" (1 Samuel 16:7, KJV).

As creatures of habit, we have been indoctrinated with what a person should look like for a particular field or position and how a ministry should look and how the structure of services should go. When there is a void in any area, those in authority will tend to first look to those that LOOK like they fit the mold.

This may frustrate you if you are not of the image or likeness people expect. You are not a cookie-cutter preacher. You are not a status quo businessman, or woman. You have been anointed for such a time as this! You are full of innovative ideas. While others want to stay within the lines, you have ways of how to stretch those lines, and even draw new ones. Fresh oil has been poured into you to refresh the industry in which you are connected to. But it seems like everyone gets called in the room but you. You've been waiting for your name to be called and it seems like you're always overlooked.

Don't get impatient! Don't get ahead of yourself. More importantly don't get ahead of God. While you think you're being overlooked, God is just exposing the fact that He's no longer moving in an old wine skin. He is about to call your name

to reveal to the world the new wineskin. But just because you've been anointed it is not your job show up and tell everybody in the room that you are appointed.

Your name is being spoken in rooms that you are not in. But if you were in these rooms, the conversation would change. There are things being spoken about you, that your spirit is not ready to hear. Samuel asked Jesse, "are here all thy children?" Jesse answers him and says, "there remains yet the youngest, and behold he keepeth the sheep" (1 Samuel 16:11, KJV).

Many of us have read this text and felt the pain of rejection that David must have felt. His own father forgot he existed? The only reason that he would remember that he even had another son is because the prophet had to ask him if there were any other? We read the father had him in the back, keeping the sheep. He was also the youngest. Why is the youngest the one doing the hard labor? A boy who has been forgotten and whose destiny has already been decided by his father, who seems to see no value in his own son. But there is a secret in these texts.

Notice that when Samuel asked Jesse if there was another son, and Jesse answered Samuel, David is not in the room. We read of Jesse forgetting about David. But David was not present to hear the conversation. Because David was not in the room to hear the conversation, he doesn't have to deal with being in a state of offense and hurt against his father.

Many of us have been offended because we walked into rooms prematurely and were not ready to hear the content that was being spoken in them. In the conversations where your

name is being mentioned, there are people involved that God has put your name in their spirit. But they are also people that are saying things like:

“He/she doesn’t have what it takes,”

“Do you know what they’ve done?”

“I know somebody that can do it better than they can.”

If you force your way into rooms you’ve been appointed but not prepared for, your heart may not be prepared for the things that are being spoken about you. It can make you bitter and resentful, and if you’re not careful, you could say or do something that sabotages you ever being productive in that room. Be patient and allow God the time to prepare and equip you for what will be spoken once you are summoned in.

The Brothers

David has seven brothers but the Bible only mentions the names of three of them: Eliab, Abinadab, and Shammah.

Eliab means, “*god of his father.*” These are people that have talent, know how to speak, look good, manipulate emotions, but don’t know God for themselves. They only know him through the experiences of others. They know that in the name of Jesus demons are casted out. But they know this because they’ve seen others do it. They know that there is power in prayer but it is not based on their weak or non-existent prayer life. They know that the Bible is the bread of life, but it is not based on their seeking of the word of God. They know that Jesus is a God that communes, but it is not based on their intimate relationship with the Lord.

Abinadab means “father of liberality.” Liberality means “the ability to be open to new ideas and free from prejudice.” These are the people that have no boundaries. They think that because everything is available everything is permissible. They have the tendency to operate in mixture. 1 Corinthians 10:23 declares, **“all things are lawful for me, but all things are not expedient: all things are lawful for me, but all things are edifying not (KJV).** In 1 Peter 1:16 it is written, **“be ye holy: for I am holy” (KJV).** Holiness consists of both consecration and separation. We must be set apart.

Shammah means “Ruin, desolation, waste.” These people look good on the outside. They are clean, well dressed, articulate, but they are in ruins and full of garbage on the inside. Shammahs are like the scribes and Pharisees that Jesus addressed in Matthew 23:27 & 28, when he said **“ for you are like whitewashed Tunes, which outwardly appear beautiful come but within our full of dead people’s bones and all uncleanness. So you also outwardly appear righteous to others, but within you are full of hypocrisy and lawlessness.**

Shammah's are dangerous because they have the ability to waste your time, ruin a vision that is being built, and leave areas in desolation, to then leave and find another place to operate.

God is not looking to anoint an **Eliab, Abinadab, or Shammah.** He is looking for a David.

David means, “Loving, love-token.” You might not dress the way they want you to, but you are loved. Maybe you don’t speak like they want you to, but you’re loved. You may not look

the part, but you are a love token. There is a generation rising up that wears a snapback (baseball cap), but knows how to cast out demons. There is a generation rising up, that wears vans and Jordan VI's to Sunday service, but know how to pray in the spirit. There is a generation of David's that have been prepared and it is their time to be called out of the back, to be brought

forth, and to manifest their calling because they have been chosen and anointed for such a time as this!

Anointed- Public Acknowledgement

“Then Samuel took the Horn of oil and anointed him in the midst of his brothers. And the spirit of the Lord rushed upon David from that day forward and Samuel rose up and went to Ramah” (1 Samuel 16:13, ESV).

After Samuel meets all of Jesse’s children and is told by the Lord that it was none of those that shall be king, Jesse goes and brings in David. Samuel then takes the Horn of oil, and the Bible declares that he anointed him **in the midst of his brothers**.

The prophet Samuel anointed David in front of an audience. In the Bible, anointments were attached to public acknowledgment. Aaron and his sons are washed, anointed, clothed in their priesthood robes, and consecrated before all Israel. When Jesus is baptized, the Holy Spirit descends upon him like a dove, in front of a crowd.

One of the main purposes of being anointed is to be brought out of the masses and be recognized as someone who the Lord has endowed with His oil. It is God publicly acknowledging us the way He did for his Son when He said, “For this is my Son who I am well pleased with.” Being anointed is God’s way of revealing you to the world. It brings you out of obscurity and into the light. It takes you out of the back row, out of the balcony, out of the back room, and brings you to the front stage

so that all eyes can see who the Lord has chosen to place His spirit upon, to do a work for his kingdom.

It is very important to understand that when David was summoned, he was not found idle. He wasn't being lazy. He wasn't found acting disobediently. He wasn't found operating in rebellion. David was found serving his father's house. He was working that backyard as if it was the most important job in the world. David is so focused on his responsibilities and mission, that he seemed to not even be aware that the prophet Samuel was in the house. It is not until he is brought into the house that he realizes that the prophet had come to visit.

There are so many people that are seeking for someone to pour oil over their head, but have no history in serving, learning and training by others, or submitting under another voice that is allowed to rebuke and correct them. Whenever we see someone get elevated in a certain area or forum, we tend to think that they came out of nowhere. It seems like their success happened overnight. But if we were to dig deep into their journey, we would realize that they weren't an overnight sensation. They fought a lot of lions and bears in private before God took them public.

In verse 12 it is written {about David} that he was **ruddy and had beautiful eyes and was handsome**. The word ruddy there, in Hebrew, means "red in hair and/or in complexion." I believe that David's complexion was red because of all the hours that he spent out in the sun working and shepherding the sheep. Too many people want to go from the street to the pulpit, without being pruned and developed. This is a very dangerous precedent

that is being established in these days. We see secular celebrities one day confessing Christ in their life, and the very next week singing or preaching from a pulpit. Then a couple of months or weeks later, they are still struggling with a weakness, or say something about what they “believe God is saying” and bring controversy or skepticism to the Gospel of Jesus.

I want to make something clear. I don't believe that the celebrities or secular artist are to blame. I believe it is the church. As the church, we are not to judge or discriminate based on our religiousness or belief system. We are to love the souls as Christ loves them. But the act of ministering (laying of hands, being allowed to speak into the body of Christ, leading worship, teaching) is a whole another realm.

We see the Apostles operating in miracles, signs, and wonders all through the book of Acts. But it took the teachings and instructions of Jesus for 3 ½ years for them to get it and understand it. I'm not saying that a person must be under teaching for 3 years before they can operate in their calling. But there is a Biblical foundation that there should be a level of submission to sound teaching under their belt before they are released to minister to God's people and be a representative of the kingdom of God to the world.

What Happens Next? Nothing. The Secret Training.

After the prophet Samuel anoints David to be the next king, something odd happens. Nothing. In verse 13, it says that the Prophet gets up and leaves to Ramah. But he doesn't take David with him. He doesn't take David to the Palace. He leaves him behind.

In verse 14, the Spirit of God departs Saul and he begins to be tormented by an evil spirit. King Saul's servants suggest to the king to "command your servants who are before you to seek out a man who is skillful in playing the lyre, and when the harmful spirit from God is upon you, he will play it" (ESV). There is a gap of time between verses 13 and 14. It is in this gap, that David is an anointed king with no throne, no crown, no army, no subjects, no riches, no power, and no kingdom. After being anointed, he is placed right back in the same place where he was before. This is the place of **"the secret training."**

You must realize that it is here that everything that you have been through, everything that has been done to you (good or bad) was part of your training. Nothing was without reason or purpose. Once you realize that, you must now go back to that "secret place" and operate in excellence in every area that you are functioning in. You now understand, just like David eventually did, that the defending the sheep from bears and

lions, was only to prepare him in secret for what would be his unveiling in public.

Nobody is watching. There's nobody to write down your exploits and victories for others to read. There's nobody to witness your triumphs to pass them down as folklore to generations to come. But it is here that you grow in patience. It is here that you grow in knowledge. It is here that you fine-tune your gifts. It is here that you actually defeat your greatest foes! Whatever you don't defeat in secret, will expose you in public.

But it is also while you're in the Secret Training, when God will allow the right people to find out who you are. You will have no idea that anybody is even watching. They may just happen to come across a clip of you preaching, worshipping, or teaching. They may just happened to be in a room where you were executing a small business deal. They may just happened to come across the introduction of the only book you've written. They never acknowledge it, never comment or click a Like on the video clip, or never even buy your book. But when a need arises, that only your unique set of skills and gifts will do the job, your name is spoken in the room. It's a good thing for you that you're ready because you've trained in secret.

A Need For Your Services Arises

One of the young men answered, “Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite, who is skillful in playing, a man of valor, a man of war, prudent in speech, and a man of good presence, and the Lord is with him’.
(1 Samuel 16:18 ESV)

King Saul sent messengers to the house of Jesse to say to him to send him David. Verse 21 declares, “*and David came to Saul, and stood before him.*” David has now come from the backyard to the palace. But he is not there to take the throne. He is there to aid the one sitting on the very throne in which he has been anointed to take. David could’ve look at King Saul’s condition and said to himself, “I’m not going to help him. This is God opening the door for me to take the throne.” But he didn’t. Verse 23 says, “so Saul was refreshed, and was well, and the evil spirit departed from him.” David served and ministered to King Saul, and allowed himself to be used to bring deliverance to him. That is what is called **Character**.

Verse 21 declares, “and he [David] became his [Saul] armor-bearer.” The gift will get you in the room, but it is character that will keep you in the room, and get you a seat at the table. But it is not the seat at the head of the table. It is the seat at the table of greatness, as an armor-bearer and servant.

It is here that you are exposed to levels of conversations that you have never heard before. It is here that you sit at tables where you don't talk just to show those in the table that you know some things too. It is here that you keep quiet and suck in all the revelation and ideas that great men and women have been using to get to where they are. It is here that you only open your mouth to ask questions to further expunge information from great minds to help you shift your mind and your spirit. It is here that true elevation happens. Because it is here that elevation of the mind occurs.

Heart Check - Is It Getting To Your Head?

But David went and returned from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem"

1 Samuel 17:15

David had gained access to the palace. He had been given a seat at the table. He had gone from being an unknown, pastoring his father's sheep, in the back yard, to sitting at the king's table and being recognized by the leaders. David's social status had been elevated. He found himself in a place where he could tell himself, "I'm no longer at the bottom of the ladder. My days of working in the backyard, serving in secret, with no gain or profit, is over.

But 1 Samuel 17:15 gives us a glimpse into the heart condition and posture of David. It declares, "David went back from Saul to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem." Even though David had been elevated, he didn't forget where he came from nor did he believe that his elevation meant that he no longer was responsible and accountable to his father's house.

This is one of the biggest mistakes that up and coming ministers tend to do. They believe that because a prophetic word has been given to them about elevation, or that a door has opened for them to further their walk in entering into their God-given purpose, their responsibility, accountability, and service to that church, ministry, or spiritual parenthood is over. Why

would you disconnect from the source that helped you get this far? This is why I believe that one of the most important discipleship lessons the church must teach is son-ship.

When we visit our parent's house, it doesn't matter how old we are, we always come in, not as visitors, but as sons and daughters. It's why we ask, "how can I help?" Or we instinctively clean up, do the dishes, or fix anything that we see broken. Why? Because this is Mom and Pop's house! I'm their son/daughter! That's my job! This needs to be the same sentiment when it comes to the spiritual house that we have been connected to and has been a vital part in you figuring out who you are in God.

Being a son/daughter doesn't change just because we are older, or because we make more money than our parents, or because we have children of our own. There is no such promotion in which this becomes a reality. The same should go for the spiritual parents or homes that we serve or have come from. Go back to that house and serve in whatever way it needs. Clean the toilets. Open the mail. Pick up phone calls on the prayer line. Vacuum the church. Whatever the house needs that you can supply, do it!

You need to have the heart posture and heart condition that proves you are ready for the next level. Always remember who you are and where you came from.

A Divine Appointment for Your Gift, Calling, or Office to Manifest (but not yet Appointed)

***“but David went back and forth from Saul to feed his father's
sheep at Bethlehem”. (1 Samuel 17:15)***

It is vitally important to not confuse an appointment with the time to be appointed. If you learn to obey and show up when the Holy Spirit instructs you, God will use divine appointments to enter you into what is often referred to as “accelerated destiny.” This is when God uses appointed times to accelerate your movement towards you being appointed in such a way that what was supposed to take months, even years, God does in weeks and even days.

1 Samuel 17 begins with the Philistines gathering for battle, to war against Israel. King Saul had also gathered his armies. A “champion” amongst the Philistines comes forth. His name was Goliath. It then begins to go into detail about the stature of this warrior, how spectacular his armor was, and how incredible his weapons were. He then opens his mouth to defy the armies of God.

While this is going on, David is still serving his father’s house. The Bible tells us that he would go back and forth from the palace to his father’s house, to shepherd the sheep. It is while he

is humbly serving his father's house that an opportunity for elevation is being created.

When the giant Goliath defies God and the army of Israel, nobody from Israel's army comes forth. Not even one of David's brothers. David's father sends him to bring food to his brothers. When David shows up, he sees Goliath defying God and the army of God. When God is setting you up for a divine appointment, He usually uses a problem, need, or adversity that can only be resolved by something you carry. By an anointing or gift that God has placed in you, and has trained you in secret.

We need to stop running away from adversity. We tend to fall away and hide when a problem or a need arises. That's okay for people who are being processed in the backyard. That's okay for people who have not been battling and defeating lions and bears in the secret place. But this reaction is not for you. You have been preparing for your moment.

Now, let me make this clear: It's not that you are going to be running around looking for your "appointment." This doesn't mean that you are going to be showing up to every conference and start laying hands on everyone. The Spirit of God will lead you to your appointment. Actually when you are in it, you want to be thinking, "this is it, this is my moment!" Your mind and your spirit will be in the mindset of, "this is a problem. This is a need. This is adversity. The Spirit of God has anointed me and prepared me to defeat this Giant!"

YOUR LEVEL OF EFFECTIVENESS WILL REFLECT YOUR LEVEL OF PREPARATION

***“I went after him and struck him and delivered it out of his mouth.
And if he arose against me, I caught him by his beard and struck him
and killed him”. (1 Samuel 17:35)***

Your effectiveness, or lack there of, in that appointment, will reveal or expose you - according to your level of preparation during number 4, the secret training. When David showed up to the scene, he ran into the army to salute his brothers. But as David is talking to his brothers, he hears the giant Goliath defy God, and defy the army of God. David arises and says, “Who is this in circumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?”

Eliab, David’s eldest brother, became angry with him because he felt David was overstepping his boundaries. David answered him and said, “What have I now done? Is there not a cause?”

When God is setting you up and bringing you into your appointment, there will be a cause. It won’t be to become famous. It won’t be to receive recognition. It won’t be to get more social media followers or likes. It will be because a cause has risen and what is in you will be the remedy to that cause.

Word got to King Saul of what David was saying. The king then sent for David. When David comes to the presence of King Saul, he tells him, “Let no man’s heart fail because of him [Goliath], I will go and fight with this Philistine.” The king tells David that he cannot fight against that man. He is only a teenager; he actually says to him “you are only but a youth.” He is basically telling David, “You are not enough. You have not gone through enough.”

But David knew that he would be effective against the giant because of the training that he went through in secret. In 1 Samuel 17:34 David says onto Saul, “Thy servant kept his father’s sheep, and there came a lion, and the bear, and took the lamb out of the flock: and I went out after him, and smote him, and delivered it out of his mouth: and when he arose against me, I caught him by his beard, and smote him, and slew him. Thy servant slew, both the lion and the bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, seeing he has defied the armies of the living God.”

Because of David’s intense secret training, and his victories during that time, he knew that the giant would be no different than the lions and bears he had already defeated.

Do not despise small beginnings. It is there that the Lord is training you, for you to be successful when your appointment comes. When my wife and I started our first church back in 2010, people would often tell me that when I would preach, I would act like I was speaking to a multitude of people. The room would rarely surpass 25 people. I would often answer them, “Because this is my training ground.” I understood that

my battle at that level would be more intense than when the multitude came. It's easy to minister in a room full of 3,000 people. But can you minister, with the same hunger, with same love, with same intensity, to a room of 30 people? What you do when nobody is looking will either expose or reveal who you are, when everyone is looking.

King Saul then attempted to put on his armor on David. But after David puts it on, he told Saul, "I cannot go with these, for I have not proved them." What David was saying is, "I cannot use weapons in the battlefield that I have not trained with in secret". So he picks up his staff, five smooth stones, and his sling. And heads out of the king's tent to confront and defeat the giant.

If prayer is not a weapon that you have trained with in secret, you will not be able to wield it effectively, in public. If you have not fed on the Word of God, during the secret training, you will go into the battlefield and into your appointment without a sword. This is why, if you look into the best athletes in their respective sports, what separates them from everyone else is not their skills or their physical abilities. It is how much more dedicated and how intense their training is when nobody is looking.

Great Gains But Great Losses

David defeated the giant. He didn't even have to use all 5 stones. He only used one. He then took the giant's sword and cuts his head off. David was victorious! It would seem that the next logical step would be that David was appointed king. But the victory didn't lead David to throne. David did experience gains, elevation, and notoriety. Samuel 18:1-4, tells us that after his victory over Goliath, David created such a bond with Jonathan, Saul's son, that the Bible declares, "their souls were knitted together, and that Jonathan loved David as his own soul." It also tells us that Saul elevated David to such a place, that the King would send David out to battle, and set him over the men of war. The Bible also declares that he was accepted in the sight of all people, and also in the sight of Saul's servants.

There will be some victories on your journey to your appointed purpose that don't directly place you in that seat, but will place you in lower levels that will test your heart, motives and intentions. It will also work as a course to prepare you for your appointed purpose. Jesus said in Luke 16:10, "One who is faithful in a very little is also faithfully much, and one who is dishonest in a very little, is also dishonest in much." When you decide to live a lifestyle of seeking the word of God and allowing him to direct your path, you will experience victory after victory. Those victories will create elevation. In the elevation, you will experience blessings, gains, and great relationships.

But you must also be ready to experience jealousy, loss, and betrayal. Many times it will come from the very people that seem to be for you. They were fine while they felt that you were under them. But now that they see you're being elevated, rather than be supportive, they feel threatened.

“And the women answered one another as they played, and said, ‘Saul has slain his thousand and David his ten thousands, And Saul was very wroth, and the saying displeased him; and he said they have ascribe unto David 10,000 and to me they have ascribe but thousands and what can he have more but the kingdom’? (1 Samuel 18:7-8)

It is in this place that you must fight against taking the battle into your own hands. You cannot allow the enemy to bully you out of humility. The devil will try to get you to forfeit your position by getting you to take the jealousy, hurt, and betrayal personally, and enter into a spirit of offense. Don't let the devil move you! Continue to operate in integrity. Hold your peace. Let the Lord fight your battles. Remember this is not about your name. This is about His name being glorified. Allow God to defend you. In the meantime, continue serving and operating at the high-level that the Holy Spirit has trained you for.

This is also the place where friends and enemies will reveal or expose themselves. The Lord will use your elevation to reveal the true intentions of the heart of the people around you. Are they really for you? Can they handle your elevation? Are they truly happy about what God is doing in your life?

Your Time Comes, but It Shouldn't Be Attached to Division, Dishonor, or Rebellion

1 Samuel 18:9 reads, “***And Saul eyed David from that day forward.***” From that moment on, Saul hated David and grew afraid of him. 1 Samuel 1:12 tells us why: “***And Saul was afraid of David, because the Lord was with him, and was departed from Saul.***” The transfer of position had already happened in the spirit. Saul knew it. But notice that David never took it as a reason or opportunity to operate in dishonor, division, or rebellion. During that time and even after Saul's death dies (see 1 Samuel 31:1-6), he never went against his king. During that whole time, he knew he had been chosen to be the next king. But he refused to take matters into his own hands.

2 Samuel Chapter 1 teaches us that when David finds out about Saul's death, he mourned, wept, and fasted for his death, Jonathan, his sons, and for this from the house of Israel who had fallen by the sword. David even kills the Amalekite that claimed to have killed King Saul at his request. David tells him, before ordering one of his soldiers to kill him, “***How were you not afraid to stretch forth your hand to destroy the Lord's anointed?***”

Your time is here. Your time is now. You have been pruned and processed. You have submitted. You have been faithful in the little. Now the time has come for you to be appointed! But this doesn't mean for you to do it your way. Remember, you are

not the protagonist. Jesus is. All of it is for His glory and to establish His kingdom here on earth. The fact that it is your time, doesn't give you the right or power to walk into your appointed purpose through rebellion, dishonor, and division. This doesn't mean that its time for you to start having meetings with people to convince them that whoever is in leadership must be removed to make room for you.

This is where you must be careful to not allow a spirit of Absalom to overtake you. The Bible says in Proverbs 18:16 that ***“a man's gift makes room for him.”*** Your appointed purpose will not be to overthrow a pastor, manager, CEO, or leader. God will either remove them, and make that position vacant, as he did for David, or have prepared new territory where he will put you over it. But it is the Lord's will for you to be given that seat and for you to be put over new territory or new vision, without blame.

If the Lord is about to enter you into your new purpose as a pastor, don't try to convince people from the church you're leaving to come with you. That is disorder and ungodly. God is not in that. If God is sending you to do a new thing, He will also supply the laborers and the resources needed to accomplish that work.

Activation: Covenants Are Made

One of the main signs that confirm that you have entered into activation is your ability and willingness to enter into covenant. Entering into covenant shows that you understand your activation is not for self-gain. You were anointed, and now activated to operate in levels that you neither deserve nor qualify for. But God has elevated you and activated you, because of the posture of your heart.

The covenant(s) are also proof that you have been approved. There will always be “haters” that are operating in the spirit of jealousy, or people operating under a religious spirit that disapprove of someone like you being anointed and activated for such an assignment or position. But God will always raise covenant relationships that will stand in the gap and defend His choosing of you.

“And he [Abner] said, “Good; I will make a covenant with you...” (1 Samuel 3:13 ESV)

“And Abner said to David, “I will arise and go and will gather all Israel to my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign over all that your heart desires.” So David sent Abner away, and he went in peace”. (1 Samuel 3:21 ESV)

So all the elders of Israel came to the king at Hebron, and King David made a covenant with them at Hebron before the Lord, and they anointed David king over Israel. (1 Samuel 5:3)

David makes 3 covenants with:

1. Abner, the commander in chief
2. The people of Israel
3. The elders of Israel

Abner was the commander-in-chief of Saul's army and in charge of the military of Israel. After he makes a covenant with David, he goes and gathers the people of Israel so that David can go into covenant with them. Then, before getting crowned king, David makes a covenant with the elders of Israel. When you are activated, you enter into covenant between you and God, first. This is the most important covenant of all. You go into a covenant with God, declaring that all the glory and honor will be His and His alone. That everything that you do from this moment on will be for Him, by Him, through Him, in Him, and because of Him.

You then enter into covenant with fellow leaders, prophets, pastors, apostles, bishops, etc. This ensures you always remember this is not the "you show." You are part of a body, that when it operates together, is the strongest entity on earth (the church of Christ)! Finally, you enter into covenant with the people that you will serve. You have not been activated to be served, but to serve God's people, to show the world the salvation and greatness of Jesus Christ, and to help establish the kingdom of heaven, here on earth.

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